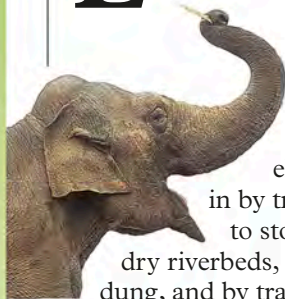




ELEPHANTS



Matriarch



Elephants have enormous ears, long noses, tusks—and weigh more than six cars. They are the biggest land mammals. Herds of elephants shape the land they live in by treading paths that are wide enough to stop bush fires, by digging wells in dry riverbeds, by fertilizing the ground with dung, and by trampling grass for zebras to eat. They also open up forests by pushing over trees!

A family of females

The leader of a herd of elephants is an old female, called a matriarch. She is followed by all her female relatives and their babies.



It's all relative

The elephant's closest relative, the hyrax, looks like a guinea pig! Millions of years ago they were huge. All that elephants and hyraxes have in common now are tusks and nails instead of hooves.

Wrinkles trap water to help to keep them cool.

Ivory towers

Many elephants are killed for their valuable ivory tusks. People have burned huge piles of old tusks to show that they want this cruelty to stop.

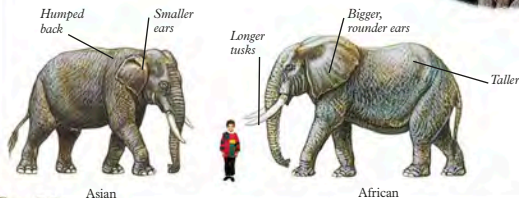


Elephants never stop growing.

Tusks are teeth. They grow about 7 inches (17 centimeters) a year and can be as long as a car!

Who's who?

There are two sorts of elephants.



Elephants eat grass, bark, and leaves for up to 16 hours a day.

This toenail is bigger than your whole hand!

